A-A-50878A
30 May 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50878
31 May 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CUP, SPECIMEN

Paper

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-C-36435 which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers a lightweight, disposable paper specimen cup, with cover, suitable for use as a container for laboratory specimens.

Salient characteristics:

The specimen cup shall be a lightweight, disposable, waterproof, cardboard container, with cover, suitable for use as a container for laboratory specimens.

The cup shall be fabricated of paperboard with the following dimensions:

Outside diameter - 3-1/2 inches plus or minus 1/4 inch
Inside depth - 2-1/2 inches plus or minus 1/4 inch

The cup shall be plastic coated on the inside as a minimum. The coating may be both on the inside and the outside. The plastic coating shall be a non-toxic thermoplastic (polyethylene) or a copolymer of vinyl chloride and vinyl acetate. The coating shall be free of any disagreeable odor and shall not contaminate the intended end use contents.

The specimen cup shall be of round, nested construction with sturdy, smooth, rolled brim and recessed bottom. The cup capacity shall not be less than 8 fluid ounces. If the plastic coating is on the inside only, it shall extend over the rolled rim. The coating shall be a continuous film and

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show no evidence of staining. The cup shall have sufficient rigidity to prevent collapsing under normal filling and handling conditions. The cup shall show no signs of leakage when tested.

The specimen cup cover shall be the coverall type forming a spillproof seal when seated on the cup. The cup shall have the specified continuous coating on the product contact side.

Cup markings shall consist of at least "CONTENTS" and "DATE" with sufficient underlined space for the required specimen information. Additional information printed on the outside of the cup shall be acceptable. All letters shall be not less than 1/8 inch in height. The ink shall be standard commercial waterproof ink generally used by the food packaging industry.

The cup shall be free of oil, grease, dirt, or other contamination.

Workmanship. The specimen cup shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing five hundred cups and covers, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one specimen cup as specified in this description.

Defects.

Cup is not complete with all required component parts.

Printing is not as specified.

Lid does not seat tightly on the body to provide for spillproof seal.

Cups do not nest.

Cup does not have rolled brim and recessed bottom.

Cup is not fabricated of Kraft containerboard.

Cup is not plastic coated on the inside.

Cup is not free of oil, grease, dirt or other contamination.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one specimen cup.

a. First article. Where a first article sample is required, all tests shall be performed on that unit.

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b. Acceptance testing. When a first article sample has not been required, one unit shall be subjected to the performance test specified herein. If a test article sample has successfully passed all tests, performance test shall not be required at acceptance.

Tests

Leakage Test. The cup shall be placed in its normal position (not inverted) and, without cover, filled with cold tap water and allowed to stand for 24 hours. At the end of the test period, the cup shall be visually examined for any signs of leaking. Any evidence of leakage shall constitute a defect.

Capacity Test. The cup shall be filled with 8 ounces of water. After filling, it shall be possible to seat the cover securely in place. Failure to hold 8 ounces of water with the cover securely in place shall constitute a defect.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-00-027-6155

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2017

Location: CID/CUP/SPECIMEN/H13-29

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
-A-50878A	CUP, SPECIMEN, Paper

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify)

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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